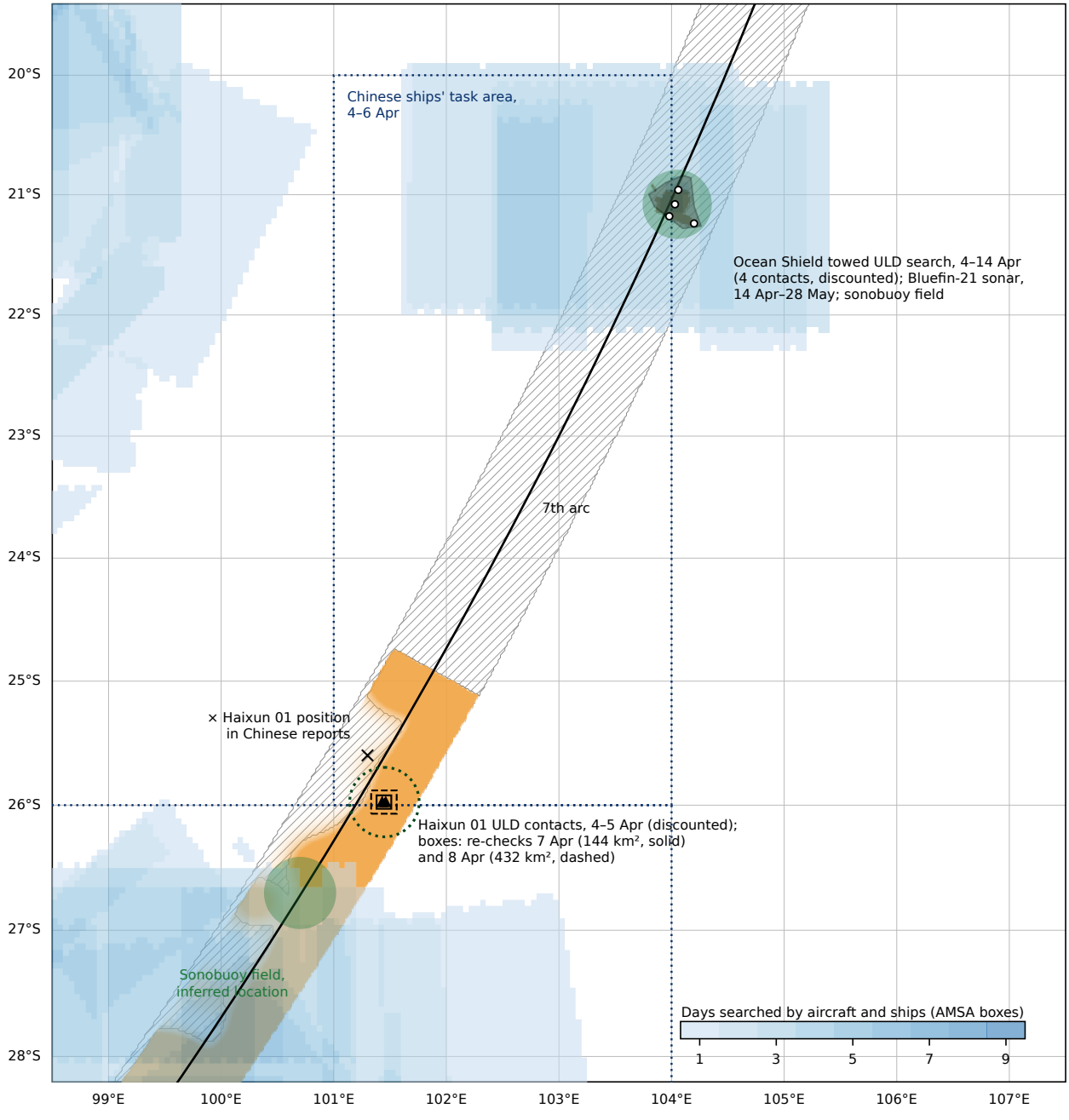
Searches for the recorder beacons, April 2014: no beacon was found, and every contact was later discounted



- Ocean Shield towed ULD search tracks, 4–14 Apr (approximate)
- Ocean Shield ULD contacts (discounted)
- Haixun 01 ULD contacts (ATSB positions, discounted)
- Haixun 01 re-check areas: 7 Apr solid, 8 Apr dashed
- Sonobuoy fields, 6–16 Apr (about 3,000 km² each, approximate)
- Sonobuoy field reported at Haixun 01 (unconfirmed)
- Chinese ships' task areas (assignments, not tracks)
- Seabed sonar, Bluefin-21 (official)
- Seabed sonar, Ocean Infinity 2018 (inferred)
- Within 25 NM of the arc, no seabed search
- Aircraft and ship search (AMSA daily boxes)

STE100: This chart shows where ships and aircraft listened for the beacons on the flight recorders in April 2014. Two ships and one aircraft heard sounds. Later analysis showed that these sounds did not come from MH370. Green areas show where aircraft dropped listening buoys; the exact positions were not published. Dotted outlines show areas given to Chinese ships; we do not know how much of them the ships covered.
Technical: ULD = underwater locating device (ICAO Annex 6; ATSB: ULB), 37.5 kHz, CVR beacon valid to Jun 2014, FDR beacon expired Dec 2012 (SIR p. 137). Ocean Shield TPL tracks and contacts read from ATSB Jun 2014 Fig. 12 (approx.; 2,400 m swath, 3 km detection range). Haixun 01: contacts 25.975° S 101.461° E (4 Apr) and about 3 km west (5 Apr) (ATSB 2017 pp. 38–39); Chinese reports give 25.6° S 101.3° E (×); re-checks 7 Apr: two contacts as base, ±5 km E–W, ±6 km N–S, 144 km² (Haixun 01, Dong Hai Jiu 101, naval ships 999 and 998, HMS Echo); 8 Apr: 432 km² (Haixun 01 west, Dong Hai Jiu 101 centre, 999 east, HMS Echo) (Xinhua via 12371.cn). Earlier hydrophone dips by Haixun 01, and HMS Echo's 6,000 sq mi of listening by 14 Apr, have no published positions. Chinese task area 20–26° S, 101–104° E set 4 Apr (Xinhua, 5 Apr). Sonobuoys (RAAF AP-3C, up to 84 per sortie, hydrophones at about 300 m, about 3,000 km² per sortie, 6–16 Apr): positions not published; fields drawn at the Ocean Shield contacts ('dozens' dropped 9 Apr) and at the location ATSB Jun 2014 p. 13 gives for a second acoustic detection (26.7° S, 100.7° E, inferred); ATSB 2017 also reports sonobuoys at Haixun 01 (dotted, unconfirmed). Surface boxes: GA/AMSA Search_And_Rescue_Search_Area2014, semi-transparent over seabed layers.